



Apple 14-inch MacBook Pro

Can M3 Max Game Without Throttling?

Yetnesh Dubey | yetnesh@digit.in

Apple did it! It finally happened. I recently tested the Apple 14-inch MacBook Pro laptop featuring the top-spec M3 Max SoC and it probably is the most gaming a creative/work laptop can do. But I still have the question – specifically, who was asking for a MacBook with gaming capabilities?

Even before we can begin to answer that, I still need to figure out whether the M3 Max SoC is a late mover advantage for Apple or, for the first time in many years, Cupertino is going to create a brand new category of devices i.e. thin and light creator laptops with gaming potential.

Design, Build Quality, Keyboard And I/O

My particular variant uses the top-spec M3 Max chip with a 16-core CPU and 40-core GPU, 64GB LPDDR5 RAM and 2TB SSD. To say that Apple has gone

all-in while constructing the new 14-inch MacBook Pro is an understatement. First of all, the Apple M3 Pro 14-inch MacBook Pro is constructed with environmental sustainability in mind. It's eco-friendly with 32% recycled materials, including 100% recycled aluminium for durability. In short, it is made very well and by keeping sustainability in mind.

Despite all that, the laptop looks robust and somehow manages to improve upon its already famous build quality. The laptop's deck is solid, and so is the display, and the hinge as well. You also won't find any noticeable flex anywhere on the 14-inch MacBook Pro which vastly improves the typing experience.

I have already talked about this in my previous reviews what makes a keyboard good is not just its key travel but also the stiffness of the chassis. And the MacBook delivers a fantastic typing experience, one which I don't even have to sing praises

of. However, I will say one thing though, this past year many Windows laptops I tested also came within striking distance of such a level of keyboard build quality. Notably, the HP Dragonfly G4, a business-class thin and light laptop, delivered an exceptional typing experience.

I also have similar things to say about the touchpad as well. It is just like last year's model in terms of size and works in the same way too. Windows purists, like myself, might scoff at the idea of a touchpad which doesn't click but instead provides haptic feedback, but I digress. It works well and one advantage to such an implementation is the fact that the touch bar remains level even after years of use.

The I/O is super robust on the Apple 14-inch MacBook Pro. It consists of three Thunderbolt 4 ports, an HDMI port, an SDXC card slot, a headphone jack, and a MagSafe 3 port. For the uninitiated, MagSafe 3 was introduced in Apple's 2021 MacBook Pros to deliver fast charging to M1 Pro and M1 Max chips, and their successors, in this case, the M3 Max. This magnetic connector, focused solely on charging, comes with a colour-matched cable as well.

You can also use one of the USB Type-C ports to charge the 14-inch MacBook Pro and I highly suggest that you do. Your cable management will also become highly convenient if you own an Apple iPhone 15 which now has the USB Type-C port, albeit it is only a USB Type 2.0 one on the base model but it is still pretty good nonetheless. The 14-inch MacBook Pro has no USB Type-A port and you get no Type-C to Type-A adapter in the box either, like you do in Dell XPS 17, which is a bummer. But I can't really complain that much with three Thunderbolt 4 ports at my disposal.

Screen And Speakers Review

The 14-inch M3 MacBook Pro is equipped with an outstanding speaker system. Its speakers are characterised by warm, realistic, and intelligible voice playback, ensuring a pleasant and accurate tonal balance for both music and video.

The dynamic range is particularly noteworthy, with sharp, precise impacts